



### Facebook AI fights deepfakes

Facebook has developed an AI system that can distort people's faces in live videos to make them look different. <https://digit.in/nov19-81>



### Google blocks 90Hz on 4 apps

Pokemon Go, Waze, WeChat and Google Maps, these are the apps that will be defaulted at 60Hz on the new Pixels. <https://digit.in/nov19-82>



# Wonders of Wi-Fi 6

Agent001 is skeptical about the upcoming Wi-Fi 6 standard being the solution to all our Wi-Fi problems

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he upcoming Wi-Fi 6 standard is no doubt being marketed as a game changer that'll make you stop

cursing at your Wi-Fi router, because no matter where you are within the range of the unit, you'll continue to enjoy a clean and seamless experience. This is because unlike previous revisions to the Wi-Fi protocol which only brought upgrades to the 5 GHz band. Wi-Fi 6 also focuses on improving the characteristics of the 2.4 GHz band by bringing some upgrades to the much neglected band as well. This should make even the budget Wi-Fi 6 routers capable of handling more clients with ease than compared to the previous gen routers.

This is certainly an upgrade but it's nowhere close to being the monumental game changer that it's advertised to be. A lot of the technologies that make Wi-Fi 6 great are also being incorporated into 5G. They're both radio-based communication standards and it makes sense to incorporate all the technologies that will improve signal reception in both of them. The improved MU-MIMO, which can handle 12 spatial streams with ease, is the primary

reason why Wi-Fi 6 will work in the manner that Wi-Fi was supposed to all these years. It takes away the onus of having a high-end Wi-Fi module on your devices to make the most of it. Even cheap smartphones with just two antennae can work seamlessly with Wi-Fi 6 routers. Also, legacy protocol devices will no longer downgrade the network performance as was the case until now. This is because the Wi-Fi 6 MU-MIMO

The only problem is that the 5 GHz band isn't as good at penetrating walls and you're left without a choice but to perform gymnastics with your device to get good signal. That all changes with Wi-Fi 6.

Despite of all these technological advancements, I don't believe Wi-Fi 6 will be that transformational. Instead, it's going to end up being an incremental upgrade like every new Wi-Fi protocol before it. There's

no one but the router manufacturers to blame for this. With every new Wi-Fi protocol, the manufacturers make decisions as to which parts of the protocol they want to implement. As a result, budget devices get their hands tied behind their backs while the premium devices get all the love. Even if

it costs nearly nothing to implement the full stack of Wi-Fi 6, we'll never see it in the lower-end router models because that results in fewer router models that can be sold by the manufacturers. So you can rest assured that when Wi-Fi 6 devices become widespread in the market, you will not experience any transformational change with your experience.

Every innovation in that space is seen as an opportunity to cut costs in



can easily dedicate an entire spatial stream to the slowest device and isolate it from the rest. Who doesn't experience this in their homes? No matter how you configure your home network, there will be that one ancient 802.11a/b device that would degrade the entire network. The usual solution was to get a dual-band router and relegate slower devices to the 2.4 GHz band and keep all the newer devices on the faster 5 GHz.